4/9/2025 - 22-E-0072; 25-G-0073 - Public Statement Hearing

STATE OF NEW YORK

PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

CASE 25-E-0072 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Electric Service.

CASE 25-G-0073 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Gas Service.

PUBLIC STATEMENT HEARING

DATE: APRIL 9, 2025 AT 1:00 P.M.

LOCATION: WebEx

BEFORE: ALJ JAMES A. COSTELLO

Reported by Vanessa Gonzalez, CER

4/9/2025 - 22-E-0072; 25-G-0073 - Public Statement Hearing

(The hearing commenced at 1:00 p.m.).

A.L.J. COSTELLO: We're on the record. I call Case 25-E-0072, Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York Inc. for Electric Service, and Case 25-G-0073, Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York Inc. for Gas Service.

Good afternoon. My name is James Costello. I am an administrative law judge for the Department of Public Service. Administrative Law Judges Tara Kersey and Nicholas Planty are also here today. And together we are responsible for presiding over the hearings in these cases and the development of a complete record in these proceedings.

Assisting us today is Joseph White and Esmin Brown-Anderson from the Department's Office of Consumer Services. We are here for a public statement hearing that was noticed on March 11, 2025. We will be holding an additional virtual public statement hearing this evening at 5:30 p.m.

And in addition to that, we will be scheduling in-person public statement hearings

throughout Con Edison's service territory, and a notice of those in-person public statement hearings will be issued after those are scheduled.

I'll briefly provide some background information before we return to receiving your comments. Con Edison filed amendments to its electric and gas tariff schedules on January 31st, 2025, proposing to increase its annual, electric, and gas delivery revenues for the 12-month period ending December 31st, 2026.

Con Edison proposes to increase its electric delivery revenues by approximately 1.6 billion dollars, which represents an 11.4 percent increase in total revenues or an 18 percent increase in base delivery revenues. It also proposes to increase its national gas delivery revenues by approximately 440 million dollars, which would represent a 19.1 percent increase in total revenues or a 25.1 percent increase in base delivery revenues.

The actual impacts of those increases on bills would vary depending on revenue allocation and rate design. So the impacts on individual customers will vary depending on revenue allocation and rate design.

Under New York State law, the Public Service Commission must consider a utility's proposal, and it may adopt it or reject it in whole or in part, or it may modify it. This hearing is being held so you can provide your comments on Con Edison's proposals for the Commission's consideration.

The Public Service Commission has seven members: The chairperson, Rory Christian, and Commissioners James Alesi, David Valesky, John Maggiore, Uchenna Bright, Denise Sheehan, and Radina Valova.

At this time we have the chair of the Commission on the line with us, Chair Rory Christian. And I would ask Chair Christian if he would like to address the participants at this time.

MR. RORY CHRISTIAN: Good afternoon, and thank you, Judge Costello. I want to take the moment to, first off, thank everyone for taking the time to engage in part of the process of reviewing the submission from Con Ed and being a voice in helping the Commission determine what actions to take in response to this proposal.

This is the public process for which

we take this feedback, and it's essential that we get this feedback, as it helps support and guide future actions by the Commission. So appreciate your time today. Looking forward to hearing the conversation. And deferred to Judge Costello on next steps.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you, Chair. As I mentioned earlier, the purpose of today's hearing is to provide you with an opportunity to tell the Commission your thoughts on Con Edison's rate proposal. This is not an evidentiary hearing where you provide testimony under oath. Nor is it a question and answer session. Rather, it is a forum for you to provide comments for this Commission's consideration.

We have a court reporter joining us who will prepare a transcript of the hearing, which will be included in the official record of these proceedings. When it's ready, the transcript will be available on the Department of Public Service website at www.dps.ny.gov.

If you are attending but prefer not to speak at this or later hearings, there are a variety of other ways you can bring your comments to the Commission's attention. As indicated and explained

in the March 11th notice, you can so do through the Department's website, by regular mail, or by telephone. And regardless of how you submit those comments, they will be given equal consideration.

But if you have comments today about existing issues with Con Edison bills or customer service, which is fine. Con Edison has requested us, though, to inform you that if you need assistance with individual accounts or customer service issues, you can contact Con Edison for assistance at area code 212-358-3791. That's (212) 358-3791. Or by email at assist@coned.com. That's A-S-S-I-S-T, the @ symbol, C-O-N-E-D dot com.

You would provide the name on your account, the phone number, service address, and nature of your inquiry. Con Edison says that these channels will be monitored from 9 a.m. from 10 p.m. tonight or today and through 5 p.m. on April 10th and 11th.

Customers will receive an initial response within 24 hours. And you can also learn more about your bill and bill pay assistance by visiting Con Ed's site, and it would be Con Ed.com/billassistance. All one word. And after

that, you can contact the company through existing channels. That is found -- can be found at Coned.com/contactus. And again, contact us is all one word.

If you're unable to resolve your issues with Con Edison, you can contact the Department of Public Service customer service help line at 1-800-342-3377. That's 1-800-342-3377 from 8:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Monday through Friday. And you can find further information about the process, complaint process, on the Department's website, again, at www.dps.ny.gov.

Okay. So we're ready to begin receiving comments. And we've had 33 people registered to speak. So when I call your name, I'd ask you if you're participating electronically to use the raised hand function so that we can identify you quickly. And if I call your name and you're participating by telephone, you would hit star 3 so that we can identify you quickly. And unmute your line.

When we do call you, we ask that you speak slowly and clearly so that the court reporter can accurately capture your statements for the record

and that you please state your name and spell your name. And if you're speaking on behalf of an organization, please state and spell the name of the organization as well.

Okay. So with that we're going to turn to our first speaker, who is Nancy Barr. And again, if you're participating electronically, you would hit the raise hand function. Okay, just give us a moment to -- it looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. NANCY BARR: Thank you. Thank you for this opportunity to speak this afternoon. My name is Nancy Barr, and I'm the -- and that's N-A-N-C-Y B-A-R-R. And I'm the Westchester County legislator representing District 6, which includes the Villages of Port Chester and Rye Brook, and most of the Town of Harrison.

I would like to commend you for accommodating our request to hold an in-person hearing in Westchester County, which I believe you said yesterday. I think in the year 2025 it is reasonable and appropriate to offer the public both in-person and remote options for expressing their concerns, particularly in Westchester, where a

majority of our over one million residents are Con Ed customers.

Once there is a plan in place, I will let my constituents know the details. But I'm here today because I have received numerous complaints from constituents who have seen the delivery portion of their Con Edison bill double, triple, and even quadruple over the last few months.

While this type of increase would be difficult for anyone to manage, it's particularly difficult, if not impossible, for people on a fixed income such as senior citizens. When talking about people who have lived in their homes for over 20 years, have paid off their mortgage, and our living off of their Social Security checks and whatever savings they have managed to accumulate, they do what they can to manage costs, including keeping the temperature in their homes lower than what might be comfortable. But there is nothing they can do to manage the soaring delivery costs on their Con Edison bills.

I understand that delivery costs are not what we typically think of as a delivery. A truck coming to someone's home and filling the tank

with gas, for example. I understand that it includes the costs of maintaining the infrastructure that brings the gas and electricity to people's homes. I realize that it is costly to harden the infrastructure to withstand today's storms, to keep trees from interfering with overhead lines, and to replace old poles and lines that have weathered 20 years -- after 20 years of harsh weather.

I also understand that transitions can be difficult, because as customers begin to transition away from gas to alternatives like geothermal energy, it is still necessary to maintain old gas lines for people who need it.

But what I do not understand is how Con Edison can continue to give its top executives large salary increases and its investors big dividends while pricing their customers out of their homes with astronomical hikes in their delivery costs. This is simply not sustainable.

Currently, state lawmakers are working on ways to make the rate-making more fair and transparent. But until those bills are passed and signed into law, there are thousands of seniors who are counting on you to keep them from having to sell

their homes just to keep the lights on. Thank you for your time.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you very much for your comments. Our next speaker is Shanae Williams. Shanae Williams? Other people that are raising their hands at this time, I'd ask you that you lower your hands. We're going in the order that I'll be calling out the names of speakers, and the next speaker is Shanae Williams. If you are participating electronically, you would use your raised hand function. And if you are participating by telephone, you would hit star 3.

MR. JOSEPH WHITE: Not seeing any raised hands.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay. Thank you. Joe. Mr. White, I don't see it as well. Vedet [vuh-deht] Gashi? Or Vedat [vuh-daht] Gashi. I apologize if I mispronounce anybody's names today. And again, if you're participating by telephone, it's star 3. And I'm not seeing anyone.

Okay. So we'll move on to Stuart Rabin [rah-ben] or Stuart Rabin [rae-ben]. Star 3 or raised hand function. Okay, we'll go to Katherine Brezler. Okay, just give us a moment to unmute your

line. It looks like your line has been unmuted. You may give your comment.

MR. KATHERINE BREZLER: Good afternoon. Can you hear me?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Yes, we can.

MR. KATHERINE BREZLER: Wonderful. Thank you, Your Honor. My name is Katherine Brezler. K-A-T-H-E-R-I-N-E, Brezler, B-R-E-Z-L-E-R. I'm a special advisor for Strategic Initiatives for the Queensboro president, Donovan Richards, Jr. I'm here to testify on the borough president's behalf against Con Edison's proposed rate hikes, which approved would have major negative impacts on Queens families.

As you know, Con Edison is seeking approval for double-digit rate hikes for electric and gas bills in 2026. Specifically, the utility is seeking approval for an average 11.4 increase for electricity rates and 13.3 increase for gas rates.

If approved, these rate hikes will lead to a dangerous situation for too many of our neighbors in Queens. In a time when most New Yorkers are living paycheck to paycheck, a steep increase in their utility bills would seriously threaten their financial health of countless Queens families.

This is especially bad time for such significant rate hikes, as Queens residents have already experienced significant increases in their cost of living over the past five years. This inflation caused many -- this inflation was caused mainly by COVID-19's destruction of the global economy and has caused far too many families to struggle to make ends meet.

On top of this, President Trump is imposing huge tariffs on almost all foreign goods. These tariffs will further increase costs for Queens family and will push many to the financial brink. And if these proposed Con Ed rate hikes are imposed on top of all of these other higher costs, many Queens families will have to choose whether to forgo buying food, medicine, and other necessities in order to pay their Con Edison bill. In short, now is simply not the time for Con Edison to be allowed to impose such significant rate hikes.

Con Edison must cancel this preposterous rate hike. Request they come back to the negotiating table with a more reasonable request that would still allow it to make its needed infrastructure improvements without driving Queens

families into poverty.

As leaders of a borough that has already felt the negative impacts of severe weather events brought upon us by climate change, the borough president understands that Con Edison's infrastructure needs to be improved in order to meet our safe, clean energy goals. But we must strive to achieve these goals in ways that don't make life financially unbearable for ordinary families.

In conclusion, Con Edison's rate policies have a far-ranging impact on the well-being of all New Yorkers. We must, therefore, continue to fight for fairness and accountability in defending Queens residents from unjustified Con Edison rate increases.

At the end of the day, I must note that Con Ed is worth more than 30 billion dollars. Under no circumstance should a company that is so valuable be raising their rates so significantly on hardworking New Yorkers. Thank you for your time and attention to this very important matter.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment. And may I ask you to please hit the raised hand function again so that you can lower your hand

and we can recognize next speaker? Thank you.

Our next speaker is Scott Dennis. Scott Dennis, if you're calling in, it's star 3. If you're using a computer, it would be the raised hand function at the bottom right side of your screen.

Okay. Not seeing anyone. Just to note for people that as I go down the list of people that have registered, if somebody's not available when I call them out, I'll just continue to go as I've been doing. And then I will circle back afterwards and call them out -- the names out again so that there's another opportunity in case they join us later.

So with that, let's go to -- it looks like Micole Horowitz. And if you're call-in user, it would be star 3. Not seeing anyone.

Sarah Leon? Sarah Leon? No. Okay. Our next speaker will be Lisa Desamours. And star 3 if you're calling in or the raised hand function otherwise. Not seeing anyone.

Zakieh Tayyebi? Okay, looks like you've been unmuted. You may give your -- and I just ask. We're getting a little feedback, so if you have more than one audio on, you'd need to just use one

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MS. ZAKIEH TAYYEBI: Hello?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Hello. Just please state, spell your name for the record.

MS. ZAKIEH TAYYEBI: Hi. This is Zakieh Tayyebi. That's Z-A-K-I-E-H T-A-Y-Y-E-B-I. I'm a resident in Bushwick now, but I've lived in New York for about seven years. And in the last two years, the price of electricity has become, honestly, an actual issue in my life. Like, some months we struggle in our household to pay the electric bill, even though we don't -- like, we make above the average household. So I'm sure this is a much bigger issue for most people, especially the delivery charges.

Like, every month the delivery charge is twice or more than twice the actual charge for the usage. Like, every month I checked, and like, if the bill itself is $50, the delivery charge is $100 or above, and we've gotten charges of around $400, even though we try not to turn on the AC. We've tried everything that we can. And this was a problem for a lot of our neighbors too that we talk to. Everyone is shocked every month by their Con Ed electricity

bill, and no amount of trying to save energy seems to help with this problem.

So generally, if Con Ed was not a monopoly, they would not be able to increase our prices like this, and the government should not allow them to keep doing this. Thank you for your time.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay. Thank you for your comment.

Okay, our next speaker is Nichole Briggs. That's Nichole Briggs. If you're calling in, it would be star 3. Not seeing anyone.

I'll move to Robert Severance. Okay, we'll move to Cadieja Brown, C-A-D-I-E-J-A Brown. If you're calling in, star 3. Okay, Alicia Corp? Okay, looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. ALICIA CORP: Good afternoon, Chair Christian and Administrative Law Judges Costello and Kersey. My name is Alicia Corp, A-L-I-C-I-A, Corp, C-O-R-P, and I use she/her pronouns, and I'm the supervisor of direct services and counsel for the Public Utility Law Project or PULP for short.

PULP is a 40-year-old non-profit with a mission of educating, advocating, and litigating on

behalf of New York State's low-income utility customers. PULP is an active party in both cases, and we will be submitting testimony on May 30th, but today our message is one of reflection. It's important for the Commission to be aware of how Con Edison customers are doing right now and the struggles to afford their current bills.

PULP has many concerns with low- and moderate-income customers being able to afford their bills. On January 31st, 2025, the company requested an increase of 1.6 billion dollars more in electric revenue and approximately 440 million more in gas revenue. The company estimates the average residential customer's bill would increase by approximately $19 per month on the electric side for Westchester County residential customers and $46 per month on the gas side if the request is approved by the Public Service Commission.

This results in an almost $65 increase a month for a customer with both electric and gas service in Westchester County. According to the company's collections activity's report as of February 2025, 400,740 customers are behind by 60 days are more on their bill with a total dollar

amount of $930,063,321.

On April 7, 2025, applications for both the regular home energy assistance program, also known as HEAP, and the emergency grant closed, leaving low-income New Yorkers without this vital financial assistance option as we enter into spring and summer.

Additionally, PULP pulled financial statistics from the New York State Community Action Association's 2024 poverty report, United Way's Alice Project, and the New York State Department of Education county statistics. In Westchester County specifically, 8.5 percent of households live in poverty with 8.8 percent of people over 65 and 25.4 percent of female head of households living in poverty.

Additionally, 40 percent of students are considered economically disadvantaged. These statistics are important and are the reality of life for many families in this area. Everyday ratepayers are already struggling with bills that are unaffordable. PULP asked the Commission to scrutinize Con Edison's rate request to make sure that the rates customers are paying are just, and

reasonable, affordable, and fair. Thank you to the Public who came out today to share their stories, and thank you for giving PULP the opportunity to speak today.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comments.

Our next speaker is Elizabeth Colon. It looks like you -- line has been unmuted. You can give your comment.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Thank you. Good afternoon, Your Honor, Commissioners, and other participants. My name is Elizabeth Colon, E-L-I-Z-A-B-E-T-H C-O-L-O-N, and I am a member of AARP New York's executive council as well as a Con Ed consumer.

On behalf of nearly 800,000 AARP New York members living in the Con Edison service territory, I appreciate this opportunity to comment on Con Ed Gas and Electric Rate cases. Many of our members are on moderate, low, or fixed incomes. They have been hard hit by the cumulative economic impacts of the pandemic, inflation, ever widening income disparity, and the annual large bill increases approved by the Public Service Commission in Con Ed's

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2022 rate case.

Before making specific recommendations about these gas and electric gate cases, I offer some general observations for context. While preparing these comments, it was useful to read the comments AARP New York made at public statement hearings for four or five previous counted rate cases.

At a public statement hearing on March 2022 about Con Edison's 2022 rate increase request, an AARP colleague spoke of the enormity of their requested increases, the largest in New York State history at that time, and urged the PSC not to increase customer charges, not to approve the requested unreasonably high return on equity, and to limit spending to the minimum amount needed to maintain safe and reliable service. There are common themes in AARP comments.

He also stated what I would repeat to today, quote, federal infrastructure dollars should be used instead of ratepayer dollars for some of the requested spending. This includes energy efficiency measures, non-wire and non-pipeline alternatives, and grid upgrade spending to handle the new load due to electrification, as well as storm hardening and

resiliency projects to address climate change.

Where federal dollars cannot be used, spending requests should be reviewed, trimmed, or phased in wherever possible. An example I would offer is the cost responsibility of electric vehicle charging stations. These subsidy costs, if even justified, should be borne by the state and federal government rather than Con Edison ratepayers, most of whom do not own a car, let alone an electric vehicle.

It is the routine practice in this state for utilities to dramatically overstate their spending needs and for the PSC to take credit for approving a significantly reduced increase. The press release issued the same day as the PSC approved the 2022 rate plan claimed that, quote, PSC cuts Con Edison's electric and gas rate request by 60 percent. Closed quote.

That claim is misleading primarily because the press release confused revenue recovery with the timing of bill increases and focused on overall bill impact rather than on delivery increases. The press release also ignored the huge costs assigned to ratepayers by PSC decisions and generic proceedings that are outside of rate cases.

AARP New York opposed the 2022 settlement reached by the Department of Public Service staff and Con Edison, as well as other institutional entities. We stated at that time the joint proposal fine by the settling parties recommends saddling residential, electrical ratepayers with delivery and fixed charges, increasing a total of approximately 25 percent residential gas heating ratepayers with delivery and fixed charges, increasing a total of approximately 14 percent and residential gas heating ratepayers with delivery and fixed charges, increasing a total of approximately 36 percent.

These increases would result in higher bills for residential ratepayers totaling one billion dollars by the end of the rate plan on December 31st, 2025. These increases would be implemented in three stages over less than two years. The first one beginning shortly after the Commission's approval of the joint proposal in May of -- June of 2023. Two, increasing again on the first day of rate year two on January 1st, 2024, and three, once more on January 1st, 2025, the first rate day of year three.

The recommended increases, although

large in and of themselves, do not reflect all the bill increases that will be in addition to the JP stated delivery increases. Various surcharges to fund mandated programs emanating from decisions in other forums and a multitude of other mechanisms in the JP design to shield utility shareholders from any negative impact of deviations from forecasts, as well as financial rewards for merely implementing state policies, and Commission regulations and decisions will further exacerbate the service territories of affordability crises.

Moreover, the joint proposal embraces state and Commission practice requiring ratepayers to fund the transition to renewable energy while simultaneously paying large sums to ensure the safety and reliability of the gas system. Con Ed's 2022 revenue requests were the largest --

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Ms. Colon, I don't mean to interrupt. Ms. Colon?

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Yes?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Ms. Colon, I don't mean to interrupt you, but you're going through a history of prior rate cases. Do you have comments about the current rate cases that's before the

Commission? I understand you're pointing out --

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Yes.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- the history of raises, but --

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Yes.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- we do have other people that are going to comment. And if you could state what your concerns are about the current rate case, that would be appreciated.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Okay. Let me continue with this. And I'll cut as long as I can as far as I go. The current request of similar magnitude. On flag 19 of Con Edison's presentation at the technical conference held on March 4th, the rate increases numbers for three-year rate plan. AARP -- and I apologize for the length of this, but the requested revenue increase will result in an annual levelized based delivery increase of 14.2 and 14.4 electric and gas for customers overall.

Due to the success in settlement negotiations of well-funded commercial and institutional ratepayer advocates at the expense of underfunded residential consumer advocates in determining which class of customers paid which

portion of the revenue increases, the delivery percentages increased for residential customers are even higher than the overall percentage increases.

So let me go. Consequently, AARP New York supports Con Edison proposal in these rate cases to improve its arrears management program so as to reduce the number of terminations as well as the amount of uncollectable debt that would be paid for by all customers.

We also support its proposal to increase enrollment in the company's EAP discount program. AARP noted in the past that EAP was significantly underenrolled. This infirmity remains with enrollment approximately at 200,000 fewer than in 2018. It appears that a major reason for the under enrollment is the way Con Ed and New York City interact with Medicaid recipients, which --

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Ms. Colon, I'm going to interrupt you because, you know, AARP is a party and has the opportunity to provide detailed information in the record. At this point, you should really be making your comments about the current rate case in front of the Commission. And I'm going to stop you if you continue to go on with the history of

things. That's fine to put in if you want to. You find it relevant in your testimony or in whatever it is that you're going to provide in the rate case.

However, we do not need a recounting of all past -- those past rate cases and detailed statements. So please, I'm going to ask you to kind of cut it short -- a little bit short at this point.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Well, let me do this, then. We have --

A.L.J. COSTELLO: No. I'm asking you to please cut it short. I'm not asking you to do anything other than please cut it short.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: And that is fine. I will cut it short. And then what I will do is submit the rest of the testimony, which is about another page. So I won't --

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Yeah, that's actually fine, and that's --

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Yes.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- that is something that we do recommend because if you can summarize what you have to say and then provide us with the full written statement, that is appreciated.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Well, I think

what I will do is stop it at this point and provide the statement fully as I was to present for you and for the record. Thank you very much.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay. And I'm sorry to have to cut you off --

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: No --

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- but we do have --

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: No problem.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- many other people. And we will put -- make sure that gets posted to the record.

MS. ELIZABETH COLON: Very good. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you.

Okay. Our next speaker is Justin (sic) Morris. Justin (sic) Morris, if you're calling in -- okay, looks like we have a call-in user 6. Just bear with us while we unmute your line. Okay, looks like you've been unmuted. If you are speaking, we cannot hear you. So you may have something muted on your end --

MR. JUSTINE MORRIS: Sorry.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: That's okay.

MR. JUSTINE MORRIS: No, I'm good. My

name is Justine Morris.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Oh, I'm sorry.

MR. JUSTINE MORRIS: That's okay. Happens all the time. Justine, J-U-S-T-I-N-E, Morris, M-O-R-R-I-S. And I am calling today not as a politician or an expert, but as a young adult trying to build a life in my first home, a home I worked very hard for and a home I want to feel secure in. But how can we feel secure when the cost of simply keeping the lights on is skyrocketing beyond our means.

Let's be clear. Con Edison is not struggling. They're not barely getting by. In fact, they reported a 1.7 billion, with a B, in net income last year. Their CEO, he made over 12 million in compensation. Meanwhile, they're asking us, regular working people, to absorb an 18-percent increase in electric rates and a 25.1-increase in delivery charges on top of the outrageous hikes we've already endured over the past three years. Enough is enough.

Westchester's already one of the most expensive places to live, and these relentless rate hikes are squeezing young professionals, new homeowners, and renters out of the county. How can

we invest in our futures when every month more and more of our paychecks go straight to utility bills? How can small businesses thrive when operating costs keep climbing?

This isn't just frustrating. It's unjust. It's corporate greed at its finest, and Con Edison just expects us to just expect it without a fight. But today we're proving them wrong. Today, we are standing together -- nearly a million residents, 38 municipalities, bipartisan leadership united against this reckless rates hike.

Con Edison's executives might sit in boardrooms making millions, but we, the people, have the power to demand fairness. We must urge the Public Service Commission to reject this outrageous increase and hold Con Edison accountable for their unchecked profits at our expenses.

This fight isn't just about numbers; it's about the people behind them. It's about young adults like me, families struggling to make ends meet, and businesses trying to survive. We are here, we are loud, and we will not be ignored. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comments. And could I just ask you to hit star 3

again so your hand gets lowered and we can recognize the next speaker? Thank you.

Alan Zaretzky? Alan Zaretzky, if you are participating by telephone, please hit star 3. Okay, we're going to move on to Cherrie Campbell. Okay, looks like we have call-in user 13. And your line has been unmuted.

MS. CHERRIE CAMPBELL: Hi. Can you hear me well?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: We can hear you, yes. Can you please just state and spell your name for the record?

MS. CHERRIE CAMPBELL: Absolutely. My name is Cherrie Campbell. That's C-H-E-R-R-I-E, last name Campbell, like soup, C-A-M, P like Peter, B like boy, E-L-L. And I am not an advocate or member of any organization. I am just a regular New Yorker who lives in the Bronx. I live in Pelham Gardens, and I have done everything that I could possibly do to reduce my electricity and gas consumption. I have changed all of the bulbs, as we have been advised to do. I have even installed solar panels. I even contracted with a different supplier who charges me 8.5 cents per therm in my natural gas.

Still, even at my relatively new, reasonable salary, I am struggling to pay Con Edison's bills. I use approximately, what, $80 in gas. I end up paying a 3- or $400-dollar bill. I don't understand. I just don't understand.

I do want to underscore some of the things that other speakers have said. Timothy Cawley makes 16 -- approximately 16 million dollars in salary and compensation. The top CEOs are making millions of dollars a year. Why is the cost of this being passed on solely to us?

I want you to know that I work full-time, and I have taken on 11 -- no, 12 hours of additional work just to be able to make ends meet. Another rate hike is going to push me over the edge financially. And if it's going to push me over the edge, what is it going to do to other people who live in my neighborhood, other people who live in the city, people who are on fixed incomes, people who don't have the opportunity to maybe take on a second job?

This is going to have a devastating -- a negative effect on our city. The young woman, Justine, who spoke a short while ago, I think she

said it really well. And she's a young person. Well, I'm not a young person. I'm 61. And it's really getting very hard to just be able to make it in this city that I used to say is my home, is my city.

It's almost as if my city hates me. And I want the Public Service Commission and everyone to really hear what I'm saying and to hear all of us. We cannot take another hike. It's just ridiculous. When you look at what we consume and what we end up actually paying in delivery costs, for me it's three to four times as much.

With that being said, I'm not here to proselytize, but I do want to quote a Quaker saying. And I say this specifically to the top CEOs, especially within Con Edison. There's a Quaker saying: Live with less so that others can live. And that's what I'm asking my elected officials and Public Service Commission to do. Deny this rate increase and make it so that those who are making millions of dollars a year live with less so that the rest of us can live. Thank you for your time. I appreciate it.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your

comment.

Just for the people that -- who are still on the line, I just want to let you know that I'm going through a list of registered speakers who have registered in advance, and I am doing it in the order now in which they've registered.

So if we have enough time, when we're finished, we may open it up for other comments, but at this time, we're going to be going in the order that I have that I call out to people based on their registration.

So our next speaker would be Pamela Gordon. And if you're participating by telephone, you would hit star 3. If you are on electronically, you would use the raised hand function. Pamela Gordon?

Not seeing anyone. Kal Salim? Kal Salim? Okay, looks like you are --

MR. KAL SALIM: Yes, hello.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- unmuted.

MR. KAL SALIM: Yes. Hello?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: You can make your -- hello, you can please state your -- and spell your name for the record, and then you can make your

comment.

MR. KAL SALIM: Sure. Thank you. Yes. My name is Kal Salim, K-A-L S-A-L-I-M. Thank you for allowing me to speak today. I'm a resident of the town of Mount Pleasant in Westchester County. And you know, obviously, I'm going to echo a lot of what my fellow residents have said today.

Basically, I remember going through this three years ago, and here we are again. I'm not going to basically say that this is going to make my life rough. This to me is basically corporate greed and theft, and they shouldn't be allowed to get away with it.

Even if I could afford to pay these astronomical rates and supply charters, I would still complain. This is just total theft. This is basically gutting the middle class and what -- if this continues, what we'll be left with is just a ghost town, and Con Edison can send bills to I don't know who, but this is preposterous.

I've been here for 14 years, and I've seen costs triple. Okay? I've done what others have said they have done -- get new appliances, LED lights, more efficient household items -- and I've

seen my supply go -- supply charges do down and at the same time delivery charges go up. So that doesn't make sense.

Are they compensating for what they're asking their customers to do? Are they compensating with delivery charges? Is that what it is? Also, relative to rates across the country, this just doesn't make sense. It does not make sense. If these rates are allowed to increase, you're basically going to gut the middle class in New York City, and people will just have to start leaving. It's incredibly insane.

You know, I'm borderline speechless. And maybe you can tell from the tone in my voice that this is insane. You know, I don't know how, first of all, the previous increases were allowed and how they're asking for more. It just makes no sense whatsoever. And I'm asking with all sincerity that they get denied outright, and not only that, review the increases from years ago and roll them back as well. Okay? Because this is nothing more than corporate greed and theft.

I would guarantee that these increases are unnecessary. And if you look at their case with

regards to why they want these increases, enhanced system resiliency, I mean, these are just -- this is a joke. You know, is this really real that they promote energy efficiency programs? They've been doing that for years. Now they're asking for increases to allow for that?

I mean, this is, again, corporate greed and theft. They're making the residents, the hardworking middle-class residents of New York, pay for their greed. That's the bottom line. And I'm vehemently requesting that you deny this. It has to be done. Thank you so much.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment. And could I ask you to please use the raised hand function again so that we can recognize next speaker? Thank you.

Our next speaker is Alan Zaretzky. Alan Zaretzky, if you are calling in, you would hit star 3 on your telephone. Otherwise, you would use the raised hand function. Again, I'm going in the order in which people have -- oh, I apologize. We have somebody that I called earlier, Stuart Rabin [rae-ben] -- Rabin [rah-ben]. I apologize if I'm saying it wrong. You have been unmuted.

MR. STUART RABIN: Yes, hello. Thank you for having me today. Do you need me to spell my name or anything like that?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Yeah, please, just so we have it on the -- correctly on the record.

MR. STUART RABIN: Sure. It's Stuart. Last name's Rabin, R-A, B as in boy, I-N. I serve as the village manager for the village of Port Chester. That is located in Westchester County. Thank you all for allowing me the opportunity to comment. I just want to read a brief statement, and then I'll be on my way.

So the village of Port Chester strongly and unequivocally opposes the proposed electric and gas rate increases submitted by Con Edison in the current rate case before the New York State Public Service Commission. These proposed hikes are not just unreasonable. They're deeply harmful, especially for a community like ours that has already been burdened by similar actions from utility companies with PSC approval.

Port Chester's home to a large and resilient Hispanic population that contributes daily to the strength and the vibrancy of our local

economy. Our community's made up of working class families, seniors on fixed incomes, small business owners, and essential workers, many of whom are already carrying the weight of rising food costs, housing expenses, and economic insecurity.

These proposed rate increases would make daily life even harder and would undermine any progress toward economic stability or upward mobility for many of our residents. This proposal comes on the heels of another painful chapter, the PSC's prior approval of substantial water increases through Veolia, the private utility that supplies water to our residents.

Despite Port Chester's objections and widespread public concern, the PSC allowed Veolia to impose significant rate hikes that have raised water bills substantially. These increases were not accompanied by a meaningful reinvestment in our local infrastructure. Nor were they aligned with what communities like ours can realistically afford.

The cumulative effect of these decisions has been devastating. Saddling our residence with higher water rates from Veolia and now proposing further increases in energy costs through

Con Edison only exacerbates inequality and undermines the financial resilience of our community.

These repeated utility rate hikes have not only strained household budgets. They have also negatively impacted our long-term economic development. They deter investment, slow the momentum of revitalization efforts, and increase the costs of doing business, making it more difficult to attract and retain employers and developers in our village.

We are working hard to revitalize Port Chester from infrastructure improvements, the transit-oriented development, and support for local entrepreneurship. But escalating utility costs, especially those forced upon us without adequate justification or accountability, make it harder for our community to thrive. They drive up housing costs, place additional burdens on small landlords and tenants, and weaken our competitive edge in a region already struggling with affordability.

We urge the Public Service Commission to consider the full weight of its past and pending decisions on communities like Port Chester. Enough is enough. Our residents should not be treated as a

revenue stream for investor-owned utilities that consistently fail to reinvest in the very infrastructure they rely upon.

If the PSC is truly committed to serving the public interests, it must begin placing the needs of everyday New Yorkers ahead of corporate utility profits. The Village of Port Chester will continue to fight for fairness, accountability, and economic justice. We ask the PSC to reject Con Edison's proposed rate increases. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you.

Okay. Alan Zaretzky? And if you're calling in, star 3. Otherwise, it's the raised hand function. And I'm not seeing anybody indicating speak.

Katharine Dow? Katharine Dow? Okay, bear with us one second. It looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. KATHARINE DOW: Okay, great. Thank you so much.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Would you just spell your name? Thank you. And then you can provide your comment.

MS. KATHARINE DOW: Okay, sounds good.

So my first name is Katharine, which is spelled K-A-T-H-A-R-I-N-E. And my last name is Dow, D-O-W. So I'm calling as an individual, not on behalf of anyone else, simply because I am, like a lot of people, extremely alarmed by this proposal.

In the last year, in order to try to bring down our costs, we've installed a new energy-efficient boiler to the house. We've installed solar panels. During the winter, we closed off parts of our house, our attic and our basement, to try to reduce our costs. We added some insulation. We've basically done everything we can think of.

But between our gas and electric, as an example -- this is the highest month. As an example, between January and February, our bill was over $1,000. Gas was close to 600, and electric was about 450. And the biggest part of both of those charges were the delivery charge -- the delivery fee.

So during the summer, our costs come down quite a bit, but the winter costs are really high. And so, as you can imagine -- I live in Westchester, by the way, if that matters. But as you can imagine, when I heard about this proposal, I almost had a heartache because that's an almost

unbearable bill to have to face, and I just can't imagine it going up even more next winter. And I don't understand why this isn't enough for them the way it currently is. It doesn't make any sense. None of the arguments make any sense for why it needs to go up, in my opinion.

And of course, on a very personal level for me and my family, I'm very worried about what it would mean for ability to pay our bills since it's a gut punch already. So that's all I wanted to say. It's just my personal experience, but I think it's shared by a lot of other people. And I appreciate your time. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you very much for your comment.

Our next speaker is Dee Rodriguez. Dee Rodriguez, if you are participating by telephone, you would hit star 3. I am not seeing anyone, so we'll go on to Anastasias Nitis [sic]. And star 3 if you're calling in or raised hand function. Anastasia Nitis [sic]? Okay. Looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. ANASTASIA MITSIS: Hello, good afternoon. Yes, I'm here. Thank you. Hi, thank you

for the opportunity to speak today and to raise our concerns. My name is Anastasia, A-N-A-S-T-A-S-I-A. Last name Mitsis, M-I-T-S-I-S.

I grew up in Harrison, New York. When my husband and I got married, we decided to stay here. We now have three kids ages one, three, and five. I'm a stay-at-home mom and caretaker of our home and our young children. And therefore, my husband is the sole provider for our household.

Since the COVID-19 dynamic, the pandemic changed the in-office dynamic. My husband works from home. So my husband is here working from home all day. I'm home all day as well with our two young children while our oldest attend public school. Because our house is full all day long, our electricity is on throughout the day all day every day.

And now we do make it a way of life to conserve. We don't use anything unnecessarily. You know, the kids are very well-trained. Turn off the lights. You know, don't use anything if you're not actually in need of it. We conserve energy when we can, but there's also no way around it. We need to keep the lights on. We need our kids to be warm

enough in the winter and cool enough in the summer. Coupled with the fact that most of our meals are cooked at home, keeping up with laundry for a large family, our Con Ed bill is already astronomically high.

We are a single-income household, and it's becoming more difficult to afford to live here. I know many other young families who are just starting out trying to save money and plan for families' future also feel the same say.

On the other side of the spectrum, my parents also live in Westchester. My dad retired at the age of 70, and his sole income -- as was echoed earlier in the call -- is his Social Security. But he has a daughter, who is my sister, who is actually still in high school.

My parents don't know how they're going to afford to continue to live here either, despite the disturbance it would cause my sister to have to move midway through her high school career.

I am one of five children. My other siblings other than my sister in high school are all young adults, either recently married or starting their lives, their families, and they want to stay

close to me and my parents, but they don't think they can afford to live here, particularly because of rising costs and owning a home and particularly electricity and gas prices.

Please don't price families out of their homes. Don't force families to disrupt their lives and move to more affordable areas. The cost of living in New York is already so high, and Con Ed has a monopoly leaving us with no other options. Please reject these proposed price increases on behalf of us residents. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment.

Our next speaker is Jennifer Thompson. Okay, looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. JENNIFER THOMPSON: Thank you for the opportunity to speak. Thanks to all the commissioners and legislators or people who came out to support us. My husband and I are sitting here. We're senior citizens. We bought a home in Greenburgh 40 years ago. We work very hard. In our 70s. We just retired. And in March our electricity bill was over $1,000. We're on fixed income. We work hard. We should not as senior citizens decide

which room to go in and be heated or which part of the house.

We are staying here. We are not selling our house. And I would agree with -- I think it was Kal Salim who said it's corporate greed and theft. And I'll add it's unconscionable and disgraceful. I am not angry, but it's frustrating, and so I'm speaking up to let the PSC know Con Edison needs to go back to the drawing board and do something.

This is totally unacceptable. And we don't protest, but if I have to have a protest somewhere, I'm going to start it because I don't plan to sell my house and go someplace else where we have corporate executives making 12 billion dollars.

A young lady said use less. You can have less. Ten billion is a lot of money. And think of senior citizens. If you're not a senior citizen, you may get there one day and realize what it's like if you are backed up in this corner. We are not selling our house, and we're going to do all we can. And please, if the PSC do something, let them go back to the drawing board and reduce the price -- costs they're raising. It's totally disgraceful. Thank

you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you.

Our next speaker is Izzi Graj. That's G-R-A-J. If you are participating by telephone, please hit star 3.

We'll move on to Sarah Gruttadaro. Sarah Gruttadaro. Okay, looks like your line has been unmuted. Please state and spell your name for the record, and you can provide your comment.

MS. SARAH GRUTTADARO: Hello. My name is Sarah Gruttadaro, S-A-R-A-H G-R-U-T-T-A-D-A-R-O. I'm a resident of Westchester County. My husband and I are new homeowners, and we were previously renters in the city for 15 years. I'm here to say simply that the cost of our energy is untenable. My Con Ed bill this winter has reached almost 50 percent of our mortgage, and we have a small home, yet my monthly energy bills have passed $1,000 a season.

To get through this, my husband and I usually turn off or severely lower the heat and get through it with sweatshirts and blankets. But now, since we have a young baby, we have to keep our heat on to regulate her room, although we keep it as low as possible as well.

My bills are usually highest in the summer, when we're running our window air conditioners, but given the price of our winter bills, I am truly not sure that we can make it through the summer. I dread that those bills are going to cost us.

Our family has decreased our usage in the past two years, not increased. And when I call Con Ed and they walk me through my bill, it's not the energy costs that rise consistently over time. It's the delivery costs. My delivery fees on those bills have been double my supply charges, if not more.

I can't imagine, even after reading news about the proposed rate hike, how the current prices and future prices are justified to cover our infrastructure. Our families have already cut expenses to a bare minimum to make ends meet. And if these prices continue, my husband and I will have to sell our house and move out of the area within a year. Thank you for your time.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment.

Our next speaker is Cecilia Payseur. It's P-A-Y-S-E-U-R. Looks like your line has been

unmuted. Just please state and spell your name for the record and provide your comment.

MS. CECILIA PAYSEUR: Hi. Thank you. Can you hear me?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Yes, we can.

MS. CECILIA PAYSEUR: Perfect. Thank you, Your Honor. My name is Cecilia Payseur, C-E-C-I-L-I-A P-A-Y-S-E-U-R. I live in Greenpoint, Brooklyn. I'm a member of the 40 Oak/23 West Tenants Association. We're an organized community of 200-plus tenants residing in a New York City housing lottery building.

The housing lottery, when working correctly, creates opportunities for a middle class to exist in high-income and high-rent areas. It also means our community includes tenants of widely varying income levels, most of whom would be forced into making ever more difficult choices by the proposed rate increased by Con Ed.

I do not wish to see myself and my neighbors suffer firsthand due to unchecked corporate greed. My comments are short. On behalf of my community, I echo many of the protests here, and I urge those in power to oppose these egregious rate

hikes. Please do better to actively lift up lower and middle class residents, and allow them to build stability, and maybe even have the ability to thrive. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you. Our next speaker is Kimberly Scarsella. If you are participating by telephone, it's star 3. Otherwise, raise hand function. That's Kimberly Scarsella.

Moving on, Vivian or Viviam -- it's spelled with an M on our system -- Panthon, P-A-N-T-H-O-N [sic]. And looks like your line has been unmuted. You may make your comment. Please just state and spell your name first for the record.

MS. VIVIAN PANTON: Good afternoon to everyone. This is Vivian Panton calling. My last name is P-A-N-T-O-N. First name is Vivian, V-I-V-I-A-N. And I am calling today for myself and for my parents, who live in Mount Vernon. I'm calling because of the astronomical costs that Con Ed is passing on to us as individuals. The electricity, as everyone has stated, you can use a certain amount, but the delivery charge has been three times the amount for our service, and that's just not acceptable.

My parents are retired, and as of right now, their children have been helping to pay their bills because the electric costs have been just astronomical. And as everyone else has already stated, we know that Con Ed is a monopoly. There's no other supplier that we can go to, so it's not like we have an option.

At this point in time, they're making money off of the backs of the common people, whether the young people that are just getting out of college. Some of us are seniors. Some of us are starting families. And that's totally unfair.

So I'm asking for this committee to consider not accepting the proposed hikes from Con Ed and for them to, more or less, deny it because there's extra money out there. They're a corporation. They should have a budget for capital infrastructure, and they should be able to use that money that they've put aside to offset whatever infrastructure they're saying that needs to be done.

I haven't seen it living in Westchester County. I haven't seen really any improvements, whether it's for the infrastructure for the poles or for the lines. They say they're going

to do it, but we need to see the change. If you're charging us for something, we need to see what you're charging us for, and right now we don't. So I'm very upset at that. That's all that I have to say.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment.

Our next speaker is Robert Porto. Bear with us one second. It looks like your line has been unmuted.

MR. ROBERT PORTO: Hello. My name is Robert Porto. That's R-O-B-E-R-T P-O-R-T-O. Thank you for this opportunity. So of course, I, like everyone else, I think that Con Ed should not raise the rates. The reasons I think that Con Ed shouldn't raise the rates is that Con Ed has no competition. So I think the Public Service Commission should send an efficiency expert and also do an audit to ensure that Con Ed is using the money responsibly.

You know, without competition, you know, the Public Service Commission I think is our only hope here. I don't know. Con Ed doesn't seem like an efficiently run organization. Con Ed has been unionized forever. It should have a union negotiator designed by the Public Service Commission.

Many union rates are exceedingly high because pay increases are compounded. When they give you three percent increase, it's based on all the other increases over time. Okay?

So this is, I guess -- excuse me. Little nervous, but these are, like, suggestions that may help. And it's really disgraceful that they want an increase. I think Con Ed shouldn't give stock dividends. It's not that kind of company. Energy is necessity of human life. Stock is already a good, stable investment, and it's bound to go up because that's going to be our gas station of the future.

Demand for electricity is rapidly growing. So yeah, why are they getting dividends? In fact, my dividend went up. You know, it almost gets me upset, but so yeah, no dividends. And why does Con Ed contract so much of its work out? Asplundh does the tree work. Northline Utilities does a lot of the big service jobs.

It has to be cheaper to do it yourself, especially with high administrative costs that are already -- that we're already paying. The administrative costs are, you know, out of this world. Is there any transparency? I mean, the

Public Service Commission is our only hope here. Can you explain how the seasonal adjusted rate works? There's no transparency. I mean, they throw this adjusted seasonal rate on the bill. It could be anything; who knows?

Can you explain why the delivery charge is three or four times the supply charge? You know, there's no -- again, no transparency. How about the monthly service rate? I mean, even if you don't use anything, it's like a 30 or $40 rate. So it seems like, you know, they really need to be audited. They really need to be -- somebody has to go in there and really tighten down and run a efficiency -- you know, a efficiency expert should be brought in.

I don't think Con Ed seems to be a well-run organization. The poles are barely, like, standing. Some of them are on the side. They're, you know, almost falling down. And yeah, they're driving everything out. So if they can prove that they're well-run efficiency -- efficient organization, maybe they should get a raise. But it looks like a mess to me. Thank you for your interest.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment. And may I ask you to please hit the raised hand function again so that we can go on to our next speaker? Thank you.

Our next speaker is Josse Balleste. It's B-A-L-L-E-S-T-E. You're participating by telephone, it's star 3. We'll move on to Joyce.

UNIDENTIFIED SPEAKER: (Indiscernible). Sorry about that.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay, thank you. That's okay. Thank you.

Joyce Armstrong, if you are participating electronically, you just have the raised hand function at the bottom of your screen. And otherwise, if you're participating by telephone, it's star 3.

Okay. Penny Barten? Okay, it looks like your line --

MS. PENNY BARTEN: Can you hear me?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- has been unmuted.

MS. PENNY BARTEN: Hello. Can you hear me?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Yes, we can.

MS. PENNY BARTEN: Great. My name is

Penny, P-E-N-N-Y, Barten, B-A-R-T-E-N. I'm a homeowner in Harlem. And I'd just like to say that not only do I reject these rate increases, I'd actually like a refund from Con Edison at this point because, simply put, I feel they have stolen from myself and millions of other New Yorkers over recent years.

Their invoices are nonsensical. They lack transparency. How are my bills more during the periods I'm away from my home? Their delivery fees are outrageous. These services are not luxuries; they're essential utilities. Yet, this monopoly, which faces no viable competition, continues to exploit its position.

I do not for one second buy Con Edison's excuse that they need the dollars for cost of repairs. The company's been in operation for more than 200 years. The costs of the repairs are not raised -- should already be accounted for in their existing rates. But instead, they're asking working families to bear the burden of infrastructure investments while making billions in profits annually.

It's been heartbreaking to hear the

stories this afternoon, and it's devastating to know that nearly half a million households are behind their utility bills and forced to choose between basic necessities like food and keeping the lights or heat on.

What's it going to be like this summer in the scorching heat? How the executives at Con Edison can sleep at night knowing what's going on is beyond me. At worst, they are legalized gangsters. At best, they are very bad businessmen.

If utilities like Con Edison are going to maintain private monopolies, then the government must step in to protect consumers. We need legislative action similar to rent control to cap how much utility rates can be raised. For these reasons, I very strongly reject Con Edison's rate hike proposal. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you.

Our next speaker is Kiara Gerek, G-E-R-E-K. If you're participating by phone, it's star 3. Otherwise, participating electronically, it's the raised hand function. Kiara Gerek? Not seeing anyone.

Lucia Venucio? Lucia Venucio?

Okay. And before I go back and call people again, I'm just going to open it up for other people that may not have registered that would like to make a comment at this time. If you are calling in by phone, you just hit the star 3 function, and if you are --

MR. JOSEPH WHITE: We have a raised hand, Your Honor.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: I understand. And if you are participating electronically, you would just hit the -- I'm sorry, raised hand function. Otherwise, you hit star 3. And we have Gayle Pinero. Okay, looks like your line has been unmuted.

MS. GAYLE PINERO: Gayle. It's G-A-Y-L-E P-I-N-E-R-O. And I live in Hastings-On-Hudson. So you know, we're a small family of three. We've lived in our home for over 20 years. And it's absurd what Con Edison's doing, and we really do need someone to step in and look at it, because as I'm listening to all the people that have made comments, I totally agree. There's got to be something wrong there.

Con Edison has no competition, so we're forced to go with them. It's not like we have

a choice to pick another provider. You know, I mean, it's I kept my heat at 62 all winter and told people to put on sweatshirts when they came into my house. They were freezing. And it's something that we have to do. Our bills are almost $1,000 a month.

At 62 it's ridiculous. We're getting to the point where we're -- you know, we're nearing retirement. Westchester County's ridiculously expensive to live in as it is. And now on top of it we have these rate hikes, which, again, I agree with the sentiment. We should be getting reimbursed from Con Edison.

And the last thing I'll say is that we also have a home in New Jersey. My gas bill in New Jersey during the summer is $11. $11. The highest electricity bill I've ever received in New Jersey is $348. And that's with an in-ground pool and air conditioning on 24/7.

So it can be done. There's no reason why Con Edison's fees have to be so high. It's absolutely criminal, and it really does need to be looked at. So and thank you for the time.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay. Thank you for your comment. Can I just ask you to hit the -- thank

you very much.

Again, if anyone would like to make a comment. We have, looks like, Joanne. I don't have your last name on the screen, but we'll unmute your line. Just give us a second. Okay. Looks like you've been unmuted. Just please state your full name, and spell it for the record. And then you may give your statement.

MS. JOANNE NOONE: My name is Joanne Noone. First name J-O-A-N-N-E. Last name is Noone, N-O-O-N-E. And I would just like to reiterate with some of the comments that have already been made, very concerning about Con Ed even trying to propose these rate hikes. I'm calling to reject these increased rates that Con Ed is proposing.

I'm a very concerned resident of Westchester County. It also goes back to one of the comments of whether you can afford this or not afford this, it's just the whole total lack of transparency here. Definitely needs -- agree about being audited. That would be -- is a great suggestion because their bills and trying to read their bills are ridiculous.

Nobody -- and especially only having my elderly mother could not read that bill. Has no

idea what a delivery charge is. All they do is look at the number on a bill. And to see something going from 3, $400 to $1,000 is really ridiculous and should not be allowed.

I'd also like to reiterate that Con Ed is a monopoly. And it is really sad that this -- that they have this type of control on pricing. The increased revenue stream that they're looking for should not relied upon by Con Ed customers. And what they are proposing to do is really -- should be done through capital budget, not through the way that they're trying to go.

I also, you know, put out there, how do you justify adding delivery charges to every single customer that you're billing, and they're more than double of the usage charge? That makes absolutely no sense whatsoever. And just to reiterate again, I think they should be audited by an outside firm, and there's complete lack of transparency. Thank you.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you. Okay, if there's anyone else on the line, if you are participating by telephone, you can hit star 3. We have Samantha Christian. Just bear with us while we

unmute your line. Okay, it looks like --

MS. SAMANTHA CHRISTIAN: Hello?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: -- the line's unmuted. Hello?

MS. SAMANTHA CHRISTIAN: Hello?

A.L.J. COSTELLO: We can hear you.

MS. SAMANTHA CHRISTIAN: Yay.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Please just state and spell your name for the record and make your comment.

MS. SAMANTHA CHRISTIAN: Yes. My name is Samantha Christian, S-A-M-A-N-T-H-A, Christian, C-H-R-I-S-T-I-A-N. And I live in Tuckahoe with my mom. I'm her caregiver, and we are living on a fixed income. And Con Ed has been criminally increasing our rates for no reason.

But with Con Ed I don't think they -- I agree with what everybody's saying, but they only care about their shareholders, not their customers, not their constituents or residents or anything. So I think that what we can do, like what the Black Panthers did ages ago, was that we can create an alternative system, government, and ways of providing power to the people that is essentially off the grid

from Con Edison.

However, their so-called providing power at these insane, criminally high rates, we can find a way to go off the grid, on our own power sources, do it ourselves, and provide for each other at a better rate. I don't think they will budge in their rate hikes. I think they will just keep trying to please their shareholders. But I want people to know that there are alternatives and that we can collectively prepare for that just in case Con Edison doesn't decrease or provide refunds, which they all should.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Okay. If that was your comment, you were finished, I thank you very much for your comment.

Okay. Anyone else on the line who has not registered and would like to make a comment at this time? Star 3 if you're participating by telephone and raise hand function if you are participating electronically. Just bear with us.

We have a person named Alanna on the line. Okay? Looks like you have -- yes, we can hear you. And please state your full name, and spell it for the record. Then you can provide your comment.

MS. ALANNA MILLER: Hi. Thank you. My name's Alanna Miller, A-L-A-N-N-A M-I-L-L-E-R. I'm currently a resident of Westchester, but we moved from the city when I was pregnant, and we're trying to sell our apartment. And this is just one example of the theft of Con Edison. While we were living in our apartment, this time last year our bill was $81.31. And currently, uninhabited with no gas or electric being used, the bill now is $86.35.

I've called and asked Con Ed why I'm being asked for an apartment with absolutely no electric or gas being used, and they just apologized and say that they don't have an answer. Also, I just want to echo what people have been saying about delivery fees. Here in Westchester, our gas usage hovers around -- our electric -- sorry, our electric usage hovers around 200 or $300, and our delivery charges are over $1,000.

It makes absolutely no sense. We feel like we're being taken advantage of. And Con Ed is truly a monopoly. We don't have other options to go for. There's no competition. You know, in a place like America, where capitalism and the free market is supposed to be the thing, this makes literal no

sense.

You know, their executives make lots of money. They have huge bonuses. I think they need to think about reducing those bonuses to compensate for some of these price hikes that they're looking at. You know, ordinary people have no explanation for why we're paying this company these increases. So that's all I wanted to say. Thank you for your time.

A.L.J. COSTELLO: Thank you for your comment.

Okay. Try one more time. If anyone is on the line would like to -- or anyone participating would like to make a comment, just hit star 3 if you're participating by phone or the raised hand function if you're participating electronically.

Okay, I'm not seeing anyone else. So at this time, what I'm going to do is just go through the list of people that I called earlier who had registered and were not available when I called earlier. And I'm just going to call out the names. If you're there and you're on the phone, you would hit star 3. If you're there and you're participating electronically, the raised hand function.

Shanae Williams. Vedet Gashi? Scott Dennis? Nicole Horowitz? Sarah Leon? Lisa Desamours? Nichole Briggs? Robert Severance? Cadieja Brown? Alan Zaretzky? Pamela Gordon? D. Rodriguez? Izzi Graj? Josse Balleste? Joyce Armstrong? Kiara Gerek? Lucia Venucio?

Okay, I don't see anyone else indicating that they are here to speak. So with that I would like to thank everyone that made their comments here today.

I'd also like to remind everyone that we will be holding another virtual hearing this evening starting at 5:30 p.m. And as I stated earlier, we will also be scheduling in-person public statement hearings throughout Con Edison's service territory. And a notice of those in-person hearings will be issued in due course.

Finally, remember that if you want to submit comments, you may submit them through the Department's website by regular mail or by telephone. With that I'd like to thank everybody again, and we're going to go off the record. Thank you. Have a good afternoon.

MR. JOSEPH WHITE: Thank you. Take

care, everyone. I'm going to end the meeting now.

(The hearing concluded at 2:28 p.m.)

STATE OF NEW YORK

I, VANESSA GONZALEZ, do hereby certify that the foregoing was reported by me, in the cause, at the time and place, as stated in the caption hereto, at Page 1 hereof; that the foregoing typewritten transcription consisting of pages 1 through 68, is a true record of all proceedings had at the hearing.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto subscribed my name, this the 15th day of April, 2025.

VANESSA GONZALEZ, Reporter